

Window Matcha

Served through a tiny window. Filmed every single time.

What It Is

Window Matcha is a matcha bar engineered around one idea: every drink is handed out through a small pop-up window, turning the handoff into a surprise moment customers can't help but film. The cups, the signature green palette, and the minimalist design are all built to look perfect on camera. The matcha is the product; the shareable moment is the marketing.

How It Makes Money

You sell premium matcha drinks (lattes, iced, strawberry matcha, matcha soft serve) at \$6-\$9 a cup from a compact kiosk, container, or small storefront. Customers are the aesthetic-driven Gen Z/millennial crowd, office workers, students, and tourists. Margins on matcha are excellent, and because every customer films the window handoff, your foot traffic compounds for free. Branded merch and retail matcha tins add secondary revenue.

Startup Costs

- Commercial matcha whisk/frother + prep station: \$200-\$600
- Espresso/ice/blender equipment: \$1,500-\$5,000 (used market lowers this)
- Kiosk/container buildout with the signature window: \$3,000-\$15,000
- Ceremonial + culinary matcha starting stock: \$400-\$1,200
- Cups, lids, branded packaging (the visual hero): \$400-\$1,000
- Permits, food license, commissary: \$300-\$1,500
- Branding, signage, design: \$500-\$2,000
- **Realistic start: \$7,000-\$25,000** (kiosk) — lower if you start as a market pop-up

Sourcing: Buy branded cups, sleeves, and the window/signage hardware from Alibaba — search "ceremonial matcha powder bulk," "double wall paper cup custom print," and "matcha whisk electric frother." Source matcha from a reliable Japanese/wholesale supplier for consistent grade.

The Numbers

- Cost per drink (matcha, milk, cup): ~\$1.10-\$2.20
- Sell price: \$6-\$9
- Profit per drink: ~\$4.50-\$7.00
- Slow day: 60 cups → ~\$330 profit
- Strong day (good location + viral pull): 200-300 cups → ~\$1,200-\$1,900 profit
- Monthly at a steady kiosk: \$9,000-\$20,000+ gross profit before rent/labor

How To Start

1. Dial in 4-5 signature matcha drinks with consistent quality and a standout look.
2. Design the brand around photogenic cups and a signature green — this is non-negotiable.

3. Build or retrofit a kiosk/container with the small serving window as the centerpiece.
4. Handle permits, food license, and commissary requirements.
5. Soft-launch at a market or busy corner; film the window handoff for every order.
6. Run daily Reels/TikToks of the serve moment and tag your location.
7. Add retail matcha tins and merch once a base of regulars forms.

Where To Get Customers

- Instagram Reels and TikTok — the window handoff is the entire growth engine
- Local foodie / "aesthetic cafe" pages and influencers
- Google Maps, Yelp, and "matcha near me" search
- High-foot-traffic placement (campus, shopping district, tourist zone)
- Collabs with nearby bakeries/dessert spots for cross-promo

Pro Tips

- Treat the cup and the window as your marketing budget — spend on design there before you spend on ads.
- Pick the location for filming backdrop and foot traffic, not just rent; a viral-looking corner pays for itself.
- Create one limited "drop" drink each month to give regulars a reason to keep posting and coming back.